FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-28-22002

Issue Title : Saddle Clamp Bonding Finish

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	2800-00	-7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ

Other Model(s)	ECCN
	9E991

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
10/26/2022	05/02/2024	04/23/2024

Estimated Completion Date	Next Update Date
07/23/2024	06/25/2024

Revision Description

This article was updated to revise the Milestones section.

Description

Boeing has performed an audit of the in-tank fuel system tubing support features. It was found that the self-bonding saddle clamps may be attached to the structure using substitution clip-nuts with non-conductive primer. The substituted clip-on nuts may interrupt or reduce the capability of the electrical bond, which is intended to shunt lightening and electrostatic energy to the structure.

Status

The root cause of this issue was determined that Drawing 65-88700 'Material Part and Process Substitutions and Equivalents' allows the universal substitution for the non-conductive primer clip-on nuts to be used as an acceptable alternative. Clip-on nuts with a non-conductive primer finish are not an appropriate substitute for select fuel system installations. At this time, Boeing has updated all of the exisiting 737 MAX production drawings to not allow the clip nut substitution. Production line number (L/N) 8945 and on will include all drawing updates to only allow use of the clip-on nuts with conductive primer P/N BACN10YD1.

A Service Related Problem (SRP) project has been opened to address this saddle clamp bonding issue for 737 MAX production as well as the in-service fleet. Boeing has presented this issue at two Lead Airline Calls (LAC) for operator feedback and input.

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Boeing is actively working to release Special Attention Service Bulletin SB-737-28-1376 to inspect suspect 737 MAX airplanes to address the isssue.

Interim Action

Boeing recommends that operators only install the correct conductive non-primed clip-on nuts P/N BACN10YD1 when performing work on or replacing the saddle clamps for the in-tank fuel tubing.

Final Action

Boeing will revise existing drawings and incorporate a 'no substitution' callout for the clip-nuts starting at L/N 8550 and on.

Boeing will issue Special Attention Service Bulletin SB-737-28-1376 to inform operators to inspect for the presence of the primed clip-on nuts P/N BACN10YD1G and replace with non-primed clip-on nuts P/N BACN10YD1.

Milestones

Note: Target dates are based upon currently available status and have risk of future revision.

Root Cause Established: MAY-2022 (complete)
Solution Selected: MAY-2022 (complete)

Lead Airline Call (LAC): OCT-2022 (complete)
Production Incorporation L/N 8945 and On: 30-MAY-2024
Service Bulletin Release: 31-MAY-2024

FAA AD Release: To Be Determined

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Service Related Problem (SRP)	737MAX-SRP-28-0237		
Fleet Team Safety (FTS)	ISS-28-22-40436		10/25/2022

Related Categories

- SRPs - Safety : Service Related Problems in work by Boeing that have an airplane or personal safety impact

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